two highly contrasting systems. Mine was an apolitical, secular and professional army functioning as per the Constitution, an army of a democratic nation. In the case of Pakistan, it was an entirely different ball game. In between bouts of democracy, the country has mostly been ruled by the army, in one form or the other. Even when the elected civilian governments have been in place, the army has continued to wield power from behind the curtain.

Musharraf has been labelled as brash and arrogant and one who lied on Kargil. Perhaps the last word on him was pronounced by Murtaza Razvi, who wrote, 'The tragedy is not that he (Musharraf) ran a banana republic in his heyday, but that by the time he left his doomed republic it had run out of bananas.'[1]

As for me, I have been described as as an 'odd ball', a maverick, 'the architect of the Indian Army's doctrine', 'a general with a difference who shoots both from the hip and the lip', 'has a heart that's soft to the core', and so on.

How I would have felt on meeting Pervez Musharraf I cannot say. Though I was invited to the *India Today* conclave at New Delhi in 2008 and we could have met face to face, I didn't have the inclination to meet the mistrustful architect of the Kargil war, someone with double standards and one who does not hesitate to tell lies!

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[1] Murtaza Razvi, *Indian Express*, 9 October 2010.